

OakBoard production deployment

Team Lead + ChatGPT handoff | Docker, PHP, MySQL and Mailgun

One authoritative guide.

Use this document instead of old chats, screenshots, Next.js instructions, Passenger settings, Supabase notes, or manual dist-copy steps.

Instruction for the Team Lead ChatGPT

Treat this PDF and the repository DEPLOYMENT.md as the current source of truth. Guide the operator one command at a time. Do not invent missing architecture, restore old deployment methods, expose secrets, or modify unrelated cPanel services.

Non-negotiable safety boundary

OakBoard must stay isolated to onboarding.9ostech.com. Never change another website, global Apache configuration, ports 80/443 ownership, shared PHP settings, global MySQL settings, DNS for unrelated sites, or system-wide Docker resources.

Authoritative locations

- Repository: <https://github.com/mateen9ostech-hash/OakBoard-Employee-Onboarding-Form>
- Branch: main
- Production URL: <https://onboarding.9ostech.com>
- Recommended checkout: `/home/ostech/apps/oakboard`
- Private config: `/home/ostech/oakboard-config.php`

1. Final architecture

What runs where

```
Internet
|
cPanel Apache TLS virtual host: onboarding.9ostech.com only
| reverse proxy
127.0.0.1:8180
|
OakBoard Docker container: React/Vite static app + PHP 8.4 API
|
Existing external cPanel MySQL + Mailgun API
```

The container does not replace cPanel Apache and does not publish host ports 80 or 443.

Repository-owned deployment files

- Dockerfile - reproducible frontend build and PHP/Apache runtime.
- compose.yaml - localhost-only port, read-only private config, health check and isolated network.
- docker/preflight.php - rejects startup when config, PHP, database tables or Mailgun settings are invalid.
- docker/cpanel-proxy.conf.example - proxy content for the OakBoard SSL virtual host only.
- DEPLOYMENT.md - complete command-level production guide.

Data and secrets

The existing cPanel MySQL database remains the system of record. Docker does not create or replace MySQL. Credentials and Mailgun keys stay outside Git in the private PHP config.

2. Server prerequisites

Read-only checks before any deployment

```
docker --version
docker compose version
apachectl -M | grep -E 'proxy_module|proxy_http_module|headers_module'
```

- Docker Engine 24+ and Docker Compose v2 are required.
- Apache proxy, proxy_http and headers modules must already be available.
- The Docker container must be able to reach the existing MySQL host and Mailgun over outbound HTTPS.

Stop condition

If Docker or an Apache module is unavailable, stop. Do not install or enable server-wide packages until the server administrator has confirmed that existing cPanel websites will remain unaffected.

MySQL host note

Inside Docker, localhost means the container itself. Use a database address reachable from the container. `compose.yaml` provides `host.docker.internal` as a Docker-host alias. Do not change global MySQL bind settings or grants without an isolated, administrator-approved plan.

3. First deployment

Clone, configure, build and test privately

Clone outside public_html

```
mkdir -p /home/ostech/apps
cd /home/ostech/apps
git clone https://github.com/mateen9ostech-hash/OakBoard-Employee-Onboarding-Form.git oakboard
cd oakboard
git switch main
```

Prepare private configuration

Create /home/ostech/oakboard-config.php using api/config.example.php. Insert real MySQL, application, session and Mailgun values privately. Never send the file to ChatGPT or commit it.

```
chmod 600 /home/ostech/oakboard-config.php
chown ostech:ostech /home/ostech/oakboard-config.php
cp docker/compose.env.example .docker.env
chmod 600 .docker.env
```

Build and start on localhost only

```
export OAKBOARD_RELEASE="$(git rev-parse --short HEAD)"
export OAKBOARD_IMAGE_TAG="$OAKBOARD_RELEASE"
docker compose --env-file .docker.env config
docker compose --env-file .docker.env build --pull app
docker compose --env-file .docker.env up -d app
docker compose --env-file .docker.env ps
docker compose --env-file .docker.env logs --tail=100 app
```

Private health checks

```
curl --fail --show-error http://127.0.0.1:8180/api/health
curl -I http://127.0.0.1:8180/sign-in
```

Do not connect public traffic until both checks pass.

4. Connect the public subdomain

No global cPanel changes

Use the hosting provider supported per-domain SSL virtual-host include for onboarding.9ostech.com. Copy only the content of docker/cpanel-proxy.conf.example into that OakBoard-only include.

Never place the proxy rules here

Do not add them to a global Apache include, the parent 9ostech.com virtual host, another subdomain, or any file shared by existing websites.

Safe cutover sequence

- Back up the current onboarding.9ostech.com virtual-host configuration.
- Confirm the include is attached only to onboarding.9ostech.com over SSL.
- Run apachectl configtest.
- Perform only a graceful Apache reload through the cPanel/WHM-supported method.
- Immediately test OakBoard and at least one existing cPanel website.

Public verification

```
curl -I https://onboarding.9ostech.com/sign-in
curl --fail --show-error https://onboarding.9ostech.com/api/health
curl -I https://onboarding.9ostech.com/oakboard-email-logo.png
```

5. Functional acceptance test

Required before declaring production ready

- Create a 9ostech.com account and receive the six-digit OTP email.
- Verify OTP, sign in, remember-me, recovery and sign out.
- Create both two-week and four-week plans.
- Edit, preview, archive, restore and permanently delete a plan.
- Confirm one user cannot view another user plan.
- Download the PDF and email it as an attachment.
- Confirm the email logo is visible and not included as a separate attachment.
- Refresh deep routes such as /plans/{id} and /plans/{id}/edit.
- Check the mobile layout.
- Confirm at least one existing cPanel website is unchanged.

Release rule

A successful container start is not enough. Health, authentication, plan ownership, PDF delivery and an unaffected existing website must all pass.

6. Future updates and rollback

No manual dist copying

Deploy a new main-branch revision

```
cd /home/ostech/apps/oakboard
git status --short
git pull --ff-only origin main
export OAKBOARD_RELEASE="$(git rev-parse --short HEAD)"
export OAKBOARD_IMAGE_TAG="$OAKBOARD_RELEASE"
docker compose --env-file .docker.env build --pull app
docker compose --env-file .docker.env up -d app
docker compose --env-file .docker.env ps
curl --fail --show-error http://127.0.0.1:8180/api/health
```

Do not run `cp -a dist/. .` and do not deploy the repository directly from `public_html`. The Docker image contains the complete build.

Rollback to a retained image

```
docker image ls oakboard
export OAKBOARD_IMAGE_TAG="<previous-commit-tag>"
export OAKBOARD_RELEASE="<previous-commit-tag>"
docker compose --env-file .docker.env up -d --no-build app
curl --fail --show-error http://127.0.0.1:8180/api/health
```

Destructive commands are prohibited

Do not use `docker system prune`, do not add `-v` to `docker compose down`, and do not remove shared networks, volumes, websites or databases.

7. Troubleshooting and escalation

Use evidence, not architecture changes

```
docker compose --env-file .docker.env ps
docker compose --env-file .docker.env logs --tail=200 app
docker inspect --format='{{json .State.Health}}' oakboard-app
curl -v http://127.0.0.1:8180/api/health
```

- Container exits: read the startup preflight error.
- Health returns 500: verify private config, MySQL reachability and required tables.
- Local health works but public URL fails: inspect only the OakBoard subdomain proxy include.
- OTP/PDF email fails: inspect Mailgun Events, sender domain and the private Mailgun settings.
- Existing website changes: stop cutover and restore only the previous OakBoard proxy include.

Information to send back for support

- Current git commit: `git rev-parse --short HEAD`
- `docker compose ps` output
- Last 200 OakBoard container log lines, with secrets removed
- Local `/api/health` response and public `/api/health` response
- Exact cPanel error ID and timestamp, if applicable

Final source of truth

Use the latest main branch and DEPLOYMENT.md. This PDF is a handoff summary. When the repository guide changes, the repository version wins.